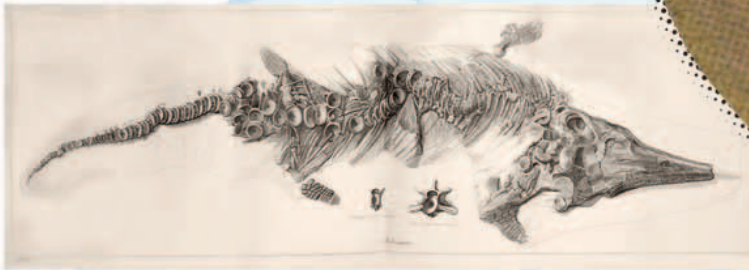


Mary Anning

The FOSSIL hunter who found dinosaur bones beneath her feet, and changed our view of evolution

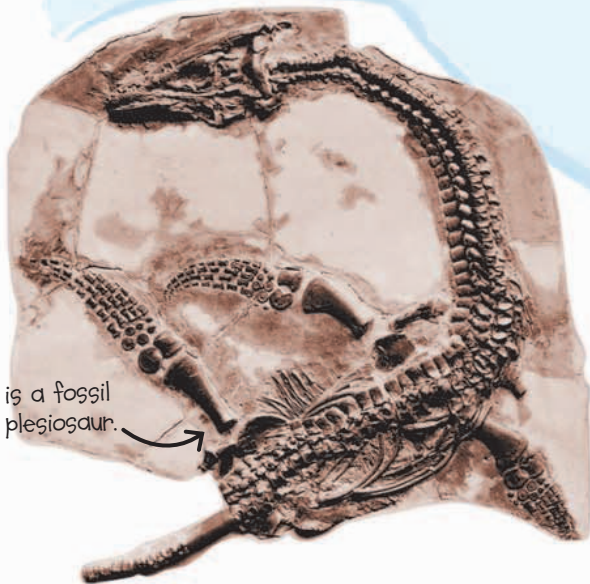
All about me

- BORN: 1799
- DIED: 1847
- NATIONALITY: English
- FACTOID: As a baby, I survived being struck by lightning.
- IN A NUTSHELL: I was born in Lyme Regis, England, an area that is very famous for its fossils.



Fearsome fossils

Mary spent most of her time searching Lyme Regis beach for **FOSSILS** with her brother, Joseph. When she was 12, Joseph found the first fossil *ichthyosaur* (above) and Mary excavated it. Mary discovered the first almost complete *plesiosaur* and the first *pterosaur* outside of Germany. She even found a fish that was the **missing link** between sharks and rays.



This is a fossil of a plesiosaur.



Evolution revolution

Mary made her **discoveries** at a time when most people believed the biblical creation story, stating that God created everything as it is today. The spectacular creatures that Mary uncovered, like the plesiosaur, were so **unlike anything still alive today** that they forced scientists to accept that the natural world changed gradually over time. Her work helped to guide science toward the **THEORY OF EVOLUTION**.